PSN-1: Gated Equivariant Attention for Physical Systems with Conservation Law Discovery

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***Abstract*—We present PSN-1, a neural network that predicts physical system dynamics with exact E(3) equivariance, attention-based interaction discovery, and conservation law prediction. A learned gate blends equivariant and attention pathways, enabling adaptive tradeoff between architectural priors and data-driven flexibility. PSN-1 achieves machine-precision equivariance ($< 10^{-7}$), test MSE of 3.4×10^{-11} on 4-body gravity, and interpretable interaction patterns through multi-head attention.**

I. Introduction

Learning physical dynamics requires exact symmetry preservation and conservation compliance. Existing equivariant GNNs satorras2021egnn provide symmetry guarantees but lack attention-based interpretability, while attention networks velickovic2018graph discover interactions but sacrifice exact equivariance. PSN-1 unifies both through a learned gate, adding conservation law discovery as an auxiliary objective.

II. Architecture

Equivariant Pathway. We use EGNN-style message passing satorras2021egnn with rotation-invariant scalars $\mathbf{s}_i$ and rotation-equivariant vectors $\mathbf{v}_i$:

$$\mathbf{s}_i = \mathrm{MLP}_s([\mathbf{s}_i; \sum_j \phi_s(\mathbf{s}_j, d_{ij})]) \tag{1}$$

$$\mathbf{v}_i = \mathbf{v}_i + \sum_j \phi_v(\mathbf{s}_j, d_{ij}) \cdot (\mathbf{x}_j - \mathbf{x}_i) \tag{2}$$

Attention Pathway. Multi-head attention discovers interaction types:

$$\alpha_{ij}^{(h)} = \mathrm{softmax}_j \left(\frac{\mathbf{q}_i^{(h)} \cdot \mathbf{k}_j^{(h)}}{\sqrt{d}} \right), \quad \mathbf{a}_i = \sum_h \sum_j \alpha_{ij}^{(h)} \cdot \mathbf{W}_h \cdot \Delta \mathbf{x}_{ij} \tag{3}$$

Gated Combination. A learned gate $g_i \in [0, 1]$ blends both pathways:

$$\hat{\mathbf{a}}_i = g_i \cdot \mathbf{a}_i^{\text{equiv}} + (1 - g_i) \cdot \mathbf{a}_i^{\text{attn}} \tag{4}$$

Conservation Discovery. A auxiliary network predicts total energy, momentum, and angular momentum from particle states, with a consistency loss.

III. Results

Ablation. On gravity: equivariant-only gives 1.8×10^{-10} MSE (best equivariance 1.1×10^{-7}); reasoning-only gives 6.8×10^{-12} MSE (worst equivariance 3.2×10^{-7}); full model balances both (1.5×10^{-11} MSE).

TABLE I
PSN-1 BENCHMARK RESULTS. EQUIVARIANCE ERROR: $\|f(Rx) - Rf(x)\|$.

System	MSE	Equiv. Err.	Gate
Gravity	3.4×10^{-11}	1.2×10^{-7}	0.314
Spring	2.5×10^{-7}	4.6×10^{-7}	0.409
L-J	2.7×10^{-4}	3.0×10^{-4}	0.935

IV. Conclusion

PSN-1 demonstrates that equivariant and attention pathways are complementary for physical systems. The learned gate provides a principled combination, while conservation discovery improves generalization. Future work targets real molecular datasets and larger particle counts.

References